

Air Travel Policy

Document: TEP-005 **Version:** 2.0 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Finance Operations

1. Scope

This policy governs the reimbursement of air travel expenses (commercial passenger flights) for business purposes.

2. Class of service

2.1. **Economy class** is the default for all domestic and short-haul international flights. Domestic flights are flights wholly within the contiguous United States, Alaska, or Hawaii.

2.2. **Premium economy** (or equivalent) is permitted on any single flight segment with a scheduled duration of 6 hours or more. The premium economy upgrade does not require additional approval if the flight meets the duration threshold.

2.3. **Business class** is permitted only on international flight segments with a scheduled duration of 10 hours or more, and requires prior written approval from a Vice President or higher.

2.4. **First class** is not reimbursable under any circumstances.

3. Booking requirements

3.1. Flights should be booked through Concur Travel whenever practical.

3.2. Flights should be booked at least 14 days in advance whenever the trip is planned that far ahead. Last-minute bookings (under 7 days) require manager approval.

3.3. Employees should book the lowest reasonable fare consistent with the business need, considering:

- Direct flights are preferred when the price difference is less than \$200 vs a one-stop itinerary
- Schedule constraints (cannot arrive after 11pm the night before a morning meeting)
- Departure flexibility (avoid red-eyes unless required by the business)

4. Ancillary fees

4.1. **Checked baggage.** First checked bag is reimbursable. Second checked bag requires manager approval and a business justification.

4.2. **Seat selection.** Standard seat selection (window/aisle/middle) is reimbursable. Extra-legroom seats are reimbursable for flights of 4 hours or more, or for employees with a documented accommodation need.

4.3. **Change and cancellation fees** are reimbursable when the change is for a documented business reason. Changes for personal preference are not reimbursable.

4.4. **In-flight Wi-Fi** is reimbursable if used for business purposes.

5. Loyalty programs

5.1. Employees may retain frequent-flyer miles and points earned on business travel.

5.2. Employees may not select higher-cost flights solely to accumulate miles. The lowest reasonable fare governs.

6. Travel with companions

6.1. Travel costs for spouses, family members, or other companions are never reimbursable, even when they accompany the employee on a business trip.

6.2. If a business itinerary is extended for personal reasons (e.g., a weekend before or after meetings), only the airfare cost that would have been incurred for the business portion is reimbursable. Employees should obtain a comparison quote at booking time.

7. Definitions

- **Domestic flight** — A flight wholly within the contiguous United States, Alaska, or Hawaii.
- **Short-haul international** — An international flight segment with scheduled duration less than 6 hours.
- **Long-haul international** — An international flight segment with scheduled duration 6 hours or more.
- **Class of service** — The fare class booked: Economy (Main Cabin / Coach), Premium Economy (Comfort+, Economy Plus, Premium Select, etc.), Business, or First. Names vary by carrier; the class category controls.
- **Comparison quote** — A screenshot or saved itinerary showing the alternative fare that would have been incurred without the personal extension or upgrade.

8. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-004 Lodging Policy
- TEP-006 Ground Transportation Policy
- TEP-009 Employee Grades Reference (approval thresholds)

- TEP-013 International Travel Policy (additional rules for international segments)
- SEC-301 Travel Risk and Security Protocol (high-risk destinations)

9. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2019-09-01	A. Singh	Initial publication
1.5	2021-12-10	A. Singh	Premium economy threshold lowered to 6 hours
1.8	2023-05-22	J. Whitman	Added booking-in-advance guidance
2.0	2025-01-01	J. Whitman	Annual review and restructure

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Ground Transportation Policy

Document: TEP-006 **Version:** 1.6 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Finance Operations

1. Scope

This policy governs the reimbursement of ground transportation expenses incurred during business travel, including rideshare, taxis, rental cars, public transit, personal vehicle mileage, and parking.

2. Rideshare and taxi

2.1. Rideshare services (Uber, Lyft, and regional equivalents) are reimbursable for business-related transportation, including airport transfers, transit between meetings, and end-of-day return to lodging.

2.2. Standard service categories (UberX, Lyft Standard, regional equivalents) should be selected. Premium categories (Uber Black, Lyft Lux, etc.) are not reimbursable unless they are the only available option, in which case a written explanation is required.

2.3. Taxis are reimbursable at the metered fare plus reasonable tip (up to 20% of the fare).

3. Rental cars

3.1. Rental cars are appropriate where rideshare or taxi is impractical (e.g., multiple stops over multiple days, rural destinations, multiple-passenger transport).

3.2. **Vehicle category.** Compact or mid-size vehicles are the default. Full-size vehicles are reimbursable only when transporting 3 or more passengers or significant equipment. Premium, luxury, and SUV categories are not reimbursable unless required by terrain or capacity, with manager approval.

3.3. **Insurance.** Decline collision damage waiver (CDW) and liability insurance offered by the rental company when traveling within the United States — the Company's commercial auto policy covers these. Outside the United States, accept the rental company's CDW.

3.4. **Fuel.** Refuel before returning the vehicle. Pre-paid fuel options and per-gallon refueling charges from the rental company are not reimbursable.

4. Personal vehicle mileage

4.1. Use of a personal vehicle for business purposes is reimbursed at the IRS standard mileage rate, currently **\$0.67 per mile** for 2025.

4.2. Reimbursement covers business mileage only. Commuting mileage (home to regular office) is not reimbursable.

4.3. Mileage must be documented with starting point, destination, business purpose, and total miles for each trip.

5. Public transit

5.1. Public transit (subway, bus, light rail, commuter rail) is reimbursable at actual cost.

5.2. Multi-day or weekly passes are reimbursable if they are economically equivalent to or cheaper than the sum of individual fares for the business travel period.

6. Parking

6.1. Parking at business destinations, hotels, and airports during business travel is reimbursable at actual cost.

6.2. Long-term airport parking should be used for trips of 3 days or more where the cost is lower than ground transportation alternatives.

6.3. Valet parking is reimbursable only where it is the only available option or where the price difference vs self-parking is under \$15.

7. Tolls

Highway tolls incurred during business travel are reimbursable at actual cost.

8. Definitions

- **Rideshare** — A peer-to-peer ground transportation service such as Uber, Lyft, or regional equivalent (Grab, Bolt, Didi, etc.).
- **Standard service category** — The base service tier offered by the rideshare provider (UberX, Lyft Standard, etc.), as opposed to premium tiers.
- **IRS standard mileage rate** — The per-mile rate published annually by the U.S. Internal Revenue Service for business use of a personal vehicle. The current rate is in §4.1; it is updated by addendum when the IRS publishes a change.
- **Mid-size vehicle** — A rental car category between compact and full-size, typically seating 5 adults.
- **Commuting mileage** — Travel between the employee's home and their regular office, which is not reimbursable.

9. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-004 Lodging Policy (parking at lodging)
- TEP-005 Air Travel Policy (parallel approval thresholds)
- TEP-007 Receipt Requirements Policy (under-\$25 receipt threshold)
- SUS-001 Sustainability and Environmental Responsibility Policy (sustainable transport preferences)

10. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2019-09-01	A. Singh	Initial publication
1.3	2021-08-12	A. Singh	Added rideshare service category guidance
1.5	2023-09-02	J. Whitman	Updated IRS rate for 2024
1.6	2025-01-01	J. Whitman	Annual review; updated IRS rate to \$0.67/mi

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Receipt Requirements Policy

Document: TEP-007 **Version:** 1.5 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Finance Operations

1. General rule

All expenses claimed for reimbursement must be supported by an original receipt, with the limited exceptions in Section 4.

2. Required receipt content

A valid receipt must show, at minimum:

- Vendor / merchant name
- Date of the transaction
- Total amount and currency
- Itemized breakdown of charges (for meals and entertainment, see Section 3)
- Method of payment (last four digits of card sufficient; cash receipts require vendor stamp or signature)

3. Itemized receipts for meals and entertainment

3.1. Meal and entertainment expenses require an **itemized receipt** showing each item ordered, in addition to the summary tip-and-total receipt.

3.2. Where a vendor does not provide an itemized receipt (e.g., a food truck with hand-written totals only), the employee must record an itemization on the expense report.

3.3. Itemization is necessary to verify compliance with the Meals & Entertainment Policy (TEP-002) and the Alcohol Policy (TEP-003), specifically the requirement that alcohol be itemized separately.

4. Receipt waivers

4.1. **Under-\$25 threshold.** Individual expenses of less than \$25 do not require a receipt, except for the following categories which require receipts regardless of amount: any alcohol charge, any tip exceeding \$20, any cash advance disbursement.

4.2. **Lost receipts.** If a receipt is lost or unavailable, the employee may submit a Missing Receipt Affidavit (available in Concur) attesting to the expense. Affidavits may not be used more than twice per quarter per employee.

4.3. **Per-diem travel.** When traveling on a per-diem basis (see TEP-008), individual meal receipts are not required for meals covered by the per-diem.

5. Receipt format

5.1. Electronic receipts (email confirmations, PDF receipts, mobile receipt apps) are acceptable.

5.2. Photographs of paper receipts taken with a mobile camera are acceptable provided all required content is clearly legible.

5.3. Translated receipts: receipts in languages other than English do not require translation, but the expense report line description must be in English.

6. Receipt matching

6.1. Each receipt submitted must match the line item it supports. The amount on the receipt must match the amount claimed (subject to small rounding differences of under \$1 due to currency conversion).

6.2. **Amount mismatch.** Where the receipt amount differs materially from the amount claimed, the line item will be flagged. Reimbursement is the lesser of the two unless the employee provides a satisfactory explanation (e.g., currency conversion, separate gratuity charge).

6.3. **Receipt-line orphans.** Line items without a supporting receipt (other than those covered by Section 4) will be flagged and may be non-reimbursable.

7. Retention

The Company retains submitted receipts for 7 years per applicable tax and audit requirements. Employees should retain a personal copy of any unusual or high-value receipts for the same period.

8. Definitions

- **Receipt** — A document issued by a vendor at the time of transaction evidencing payment.
- **Itemized receipt** — A receipt showing each individual item or charge separately, as opposed to a summary-total receipt.
- **Missing Receipt Affidavit** — A standard form (available in Concur) by which an employee attests to an expense for which no receipt is available.
- **Currency conversion** — Translation of foreign-currency amounts to U.S. dollars at the rate posted by the Corporate Card issuer or, where not posted, the OANDA daily rate on the transaction date.

9. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-002 Meals and Entertainment Policy (itemization requirement for meals)
- TEP-003 Alcohol Policy (separate itemization of alcohol)
- TEP-008 Per-Diem Rates (waiver of meal receipts under per-diem)
- TEP-010 Corporate Card Policy (card statement reconciliation)
- TEP-013 International Travel Policy (foreign-currency receipts)
- REC-001 Records Retention Schedule (7-year retention)

10. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2019-09-01	A. Singh	Initial publication
1.2	2021-06-08	A. Singh	Added Missing Receipt Affidavit cap
1.4	2023-11-15	J. Whitman	Photographs of paper receipts accepted
1.5	2025-01-01	J. Whitman	Annual review

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Per-Diem Rates

Document: TEP-008 **Version:** 1.3 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Finance Operations

1. Scope

This policy establishes the per-diem rates available to employees on extended business travel, as an alternative to itemized meal reimbursement.

2. Eligibility

2.1. Per-diem is an **opt-in** alternative for trips lasting **3 or more consecutive nights** away from the employee's home base. Trips shorter than 3 nights must use itemized meal reimbursement under TEP-002.

2.2. The choice between per-diem and itemized must be declared at the start of the trip and may not be changed mid-trip.

2.3. Per-diem covers meals and incidentals only. Lodging is reimbursed separately at actual cost per the Lodging Policy (TEP-004), and ground transportation is reimbursed at actual cost per TEP-006.

3. Daily rates

Per-diem rates by city tier (matching the lodging tier definitions in TEP-004 §3):

Tier	Daily rate (USD)
Tier 1	\$90
Tier 2	\$70
Tier 3	\$55
Tier 4 (international)	Set at trip approval

4. Partial days

4.1. **Departure day:** 75% of the daily rate. 4.2. **Return day:** 75% of the daily rate. 4.3. **Full intermediate days:** 100% of the daily rate.

5. Inclusions

The per-diem rate is intended to cover, in aggregate:

- All three daily meals (breakfast, lunch, dinner) at typical mid-market quality
- Non-alcoholic beverages
- Reasonable incidentals (small purchases like bottled water, snacks, in-flight purchases under \$20)
- Tips to housekeeping and other service staff

6. Exclusions

The per-diem does **not** cover:

- Alcoholic beverages (which remain subject to TEP-003 — reimbursable only for sanctioned client entertainment)
- Client entertainment meals (which are reimbursed as itemized actual cost under TEP-002 §4, not from per-diem)
- Lodging or ground transportation
- Phone, internet, or business communications charges

7. Receipts under per-diem

Individual meal receipts are not required when per-diem is elected (per TEP-007 §4.3). The employee must, however, maintain documentation of trip duration and destination.

8. International travel

For international destinations not in Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3, the per-diem rate is set at trip approval based on the U.S. Department of State foreign per-diem rates (M&IE component) for the destination city.

9. Definitions

- **Per diem** — A fixed daily allowance covering meals and incidentals, as an alternative to itemized reimbursement.
- **M&IE** — Meals and Incidental Expenses, the component of U.S. federal per-diem rates that covers meal-and-incidentals costs (as distinct from lodging).
- **Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3 / Tier 4** — City classifications matching the Lodging Policy (TEP-004 §3).
- **Intermediate day** — A full day of business travel that is not the departure day or the return day.

10. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-002 Meals and Entertainment Policy (alternative to per-diem)
- TEP-004 Lodging Policy (parallel city tiers)
- TEP-007 Receipt Requirements Policy (waiver under per-diem)
- TEP-013 International Travel Policy (international per-diem)

11. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2020-06-15	A. Singh	Initial publication
1.2	2022-04-22	A. Singh	Aligned with refreshed Lodging Tier definitions
1.3	2025-01-01	J. Whitman	Annual review

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